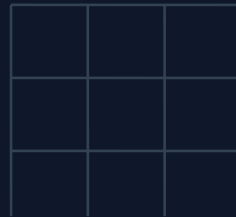


9TH ANNUAL EDITION • BEST OF JS



2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

Methodology: GitHub stars added Jan 1 – Dec 31, 2024, across projects curated by Best of JS.

1,000+

Projects Tracked

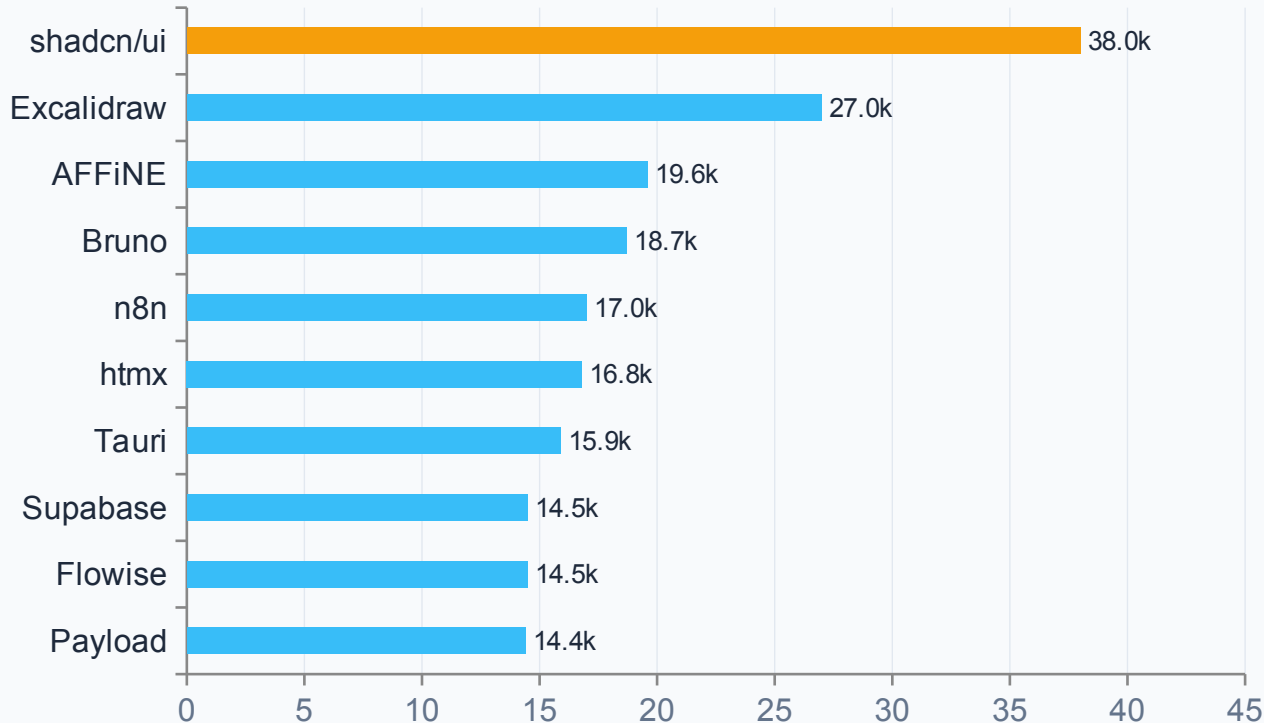
GitHub API

Data Source

2024

Edition

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE



WINNER

shadcn/ui

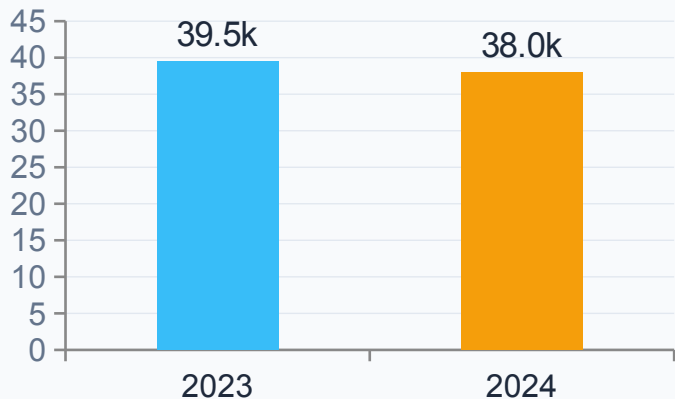
+38.0k

2nd Year
In A Row

Gap to #2:
+11k stars

Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

GitHub Stars Added



77.5k total stars (created Jan 2023)

Key 2024 Additions

Charts

Powered by Recharts — plug-and-play chart components

Themes

CSS variable generation for consistent design tokens

Blocks

Layout collections for typical web app patterns

Sidebar

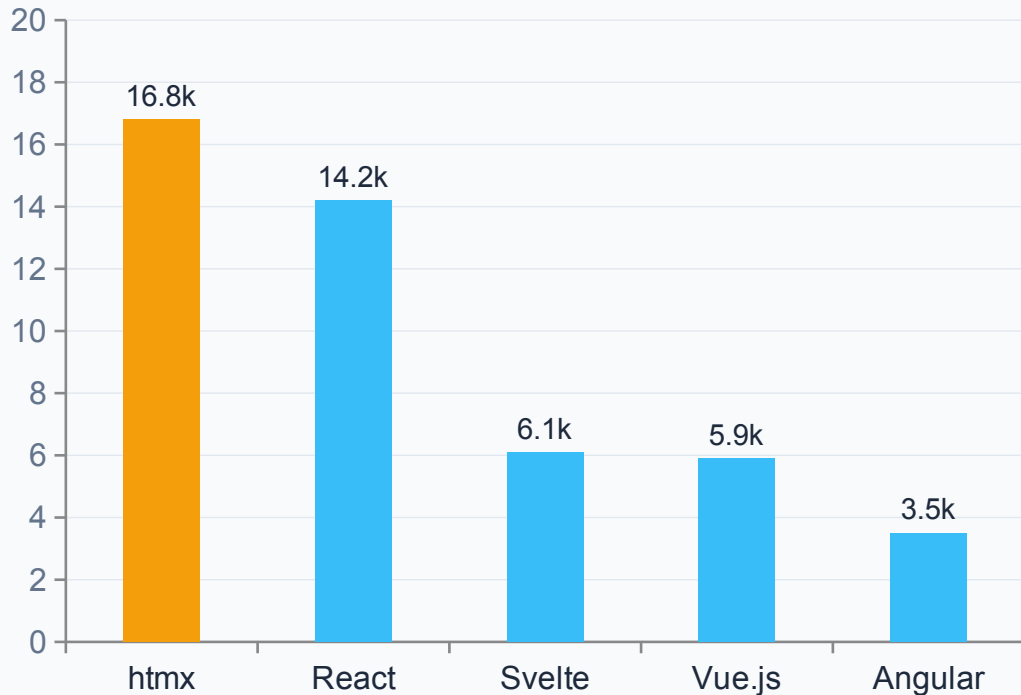
New responsive sidebar component

CLI v2

Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos + registry ecosystem

★ Vercel v0 AI + registry ecosystem (Motion-Primitives, Magic UI) fueled further adoption

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



htmx #1 ↑ (+16.8k)

Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for AJAX/WebSockets without writing JS. Rose from #2 in 2023. Ideal for server-driven, low-JS architectures.

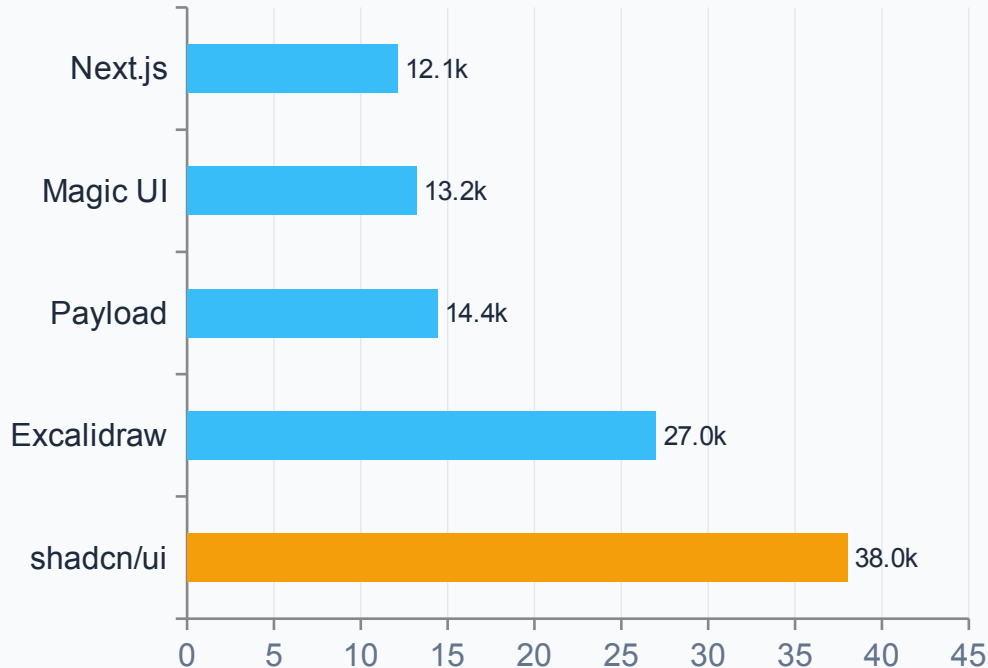
React 19 #2 (+14.2k)

Launched Dec 2024 after 3 years. Adds Server Components, Server Functions, web components, and form actions. Evolving toward a "framework specification."

Svelte 5 #3 (+6.1k)

Introduced "runes" — explicit reactive state mechanism. Holds highest positive opinion in the State of JS survey. Vue (+5.9k) and Angular (+3.5k) round out the top 5.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

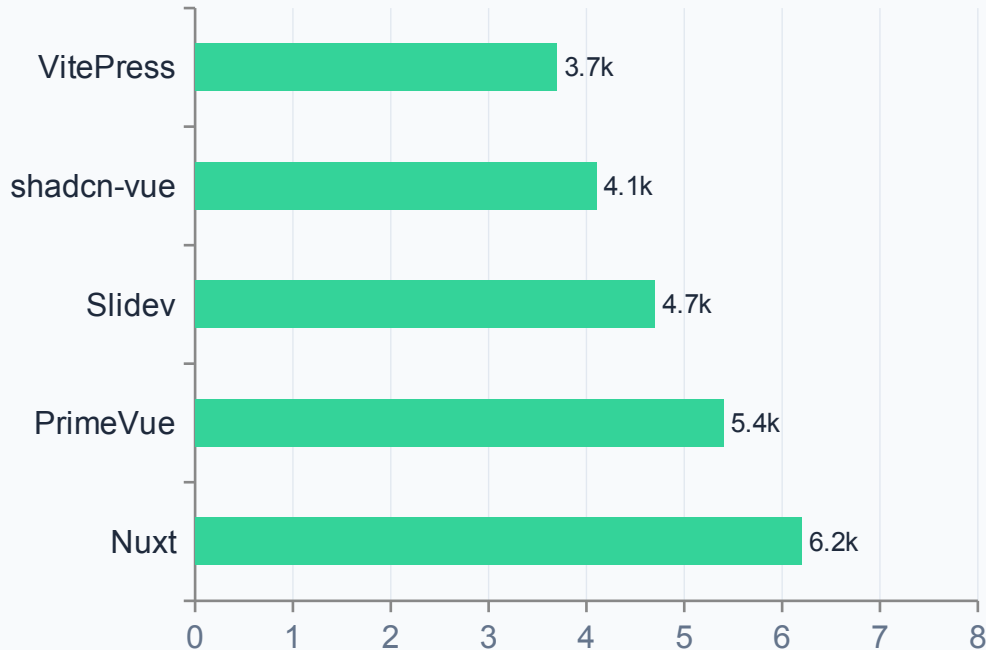


React 19: What's New

- Server Components
- Server Functions
- Custom Elements (web components)
- New React hooks
- Form actions
- React Compiler (ongoing)

*"React is evolving into **a specification for frameworks**" — Robin Wieruch*

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth



What's Driving Vue Growth

Vue 3.5 Reactivity Rework

Lighter alien-signals approach replaces the previous reactivity system — already landed in the main branch.

UI Library Wave

PrimeVue, shadcn-vue, and others signal a confident, maturing ecosystem with production-quality options.

Nuxt Leadership

Active release cycle + regular performance improvements. Core team lead Daniel Roe highlighted steady progress.

shadcn/ui's success inspired shadcn-vue — cross-framework ecosystem influence

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Tools

n8n +17.0k

Workflow automation with native AI

AFFiNE +19.6k

Knowledge base + AI capabilities

Flowise +14.5k

Visual drag-and-drop LLM flow builder

Desktop / Mobile

Tauri +15.9k

Desktop & mobile apps via web frontend

Rust-powered backend

Lighter and faster than Electron

Cross-platform

Windows, macOS, Linux, iOS, Android

Browser Innovation

PGlite

Postgres running via WebAssembly in the browser

WebVM

Full Linux VM running entirely in the browser

WASM trend

Compute-heavy workloads shifting client-side

4 of 10

top projects have AI integrations

+15.9k

Tauri stars — desktop via web stack

WASM

powers both PGLite and WebVM

4 of the top 10 overall projects have significant AI capabilities or integrations

What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

01 Component Ownership Beats Imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model won a second year, reaching 77.5k stars. Owning and customizing code beats abstracted library lock-in.

02 HTML-First is Serious Architecture

htmx overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars. Server-driven, low-JS approaches are gaining real traction in 2024.

03 React Becomes a Framework Spec

Server Components and Server Functions in React 19 mean Next.js, Remix, and others each interpret React primitives differently.

04 AI Integration is Table Stakes

4 of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have native AI capabilities. AI is infrastructure now, not a feature.

05 Vue's Ecosystem Signals Maturity

High-quality UI libraries + Vue 3.5 reactivity rework signal a confident, mature ecosystem on par with React tooling.